

TAYLOR PENTZ

Senior Software Engineer

taylorpentz2@gmail.com | 1601 Larkin, High Point, NC | +1 (980) 981-4522

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/taylor-p-b0389a3ba>

Professional Summary

Senior DevOps Engineer with 10+ years of experience in SaaS, cloud infrastructure, and enterprise platform engineering, specializing in **AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes 1.23–1.30, Docker 20–26, Terraform 1.0–1.8, and CI/CD automation**. Experienced in migrating legacy deployment workflows into secure, observable, and scalable cloud-native platforms while improving release speed, uptime, cost control, and developer productivity. Strong background in production incident response, infrastructure security, monitoring, automation scripting, and cross-team delivery for fintech, healthcare, eCommerce, and software consulting industries globally.

Technical Skills

- ❖ **Cloud Platforms:** AWS, Azure, GCP, IAM, VPC, EC2, ECS, EKS, AKS, GKE, Cloud Run, Load Balancers, Route 53, S3, RDS, Cloud SQL
- ❖ **Containerization & Orchestration:** Docker 20–26, Kubernetes 1.23–1.30, Helm 3.x, Ingress Controller, HPA, Secrets, ConfigMaps, StatefulSets
- ❖ **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform 1.0–1.8, Ansible 2.9–2.16, CloudFormation, Terragrunt, reusable modules, remote state, policy validation
- ❖ **CI/CD & Release Engineering:** Jenkins 2.x, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Azure DevOps, Argo CD 2.x, blue-green deployment, rolling deployment, release tagging
- ❖ **Monitoring & Observability:** Prometheus 2.x, Grafana 8–11, ELK Stack, Loki, Datadog, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, OpenTelemetry, alert tuning
- ❖ **Security & Compliance:** DevSecOps, IAM hardening, secrets management, SAST, dependency scanning, container image scanning, RBAC, network policies
- ❖ **Scripting & Automation:** Python 3.8–3.12, Bash, PowerShell, YAML, JSON, Linux automation, API integration, deployment tooling
- ❖ **Databases & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, Kafka, backup automation, migration support, performance troubleshooting

Professional Experience

SumatoSoft

Senior Software Engineer

Boston, MA (Remote) | Apr 2023 – Mar 2025

- Led **cloud-native SaaS infrastructure** modernization using **AWS, Kubernetes 1.27, Docker 24, and Terraform 1.6**, improving deployment stability by **28%** across production services.
- Migrated legacy Jenkins pipelines and manual server scripts into **GitHub Actions, Argo CD 2.x, and Helm 3**, reducing failed releases by **32%** and improving rollback speed.
- Designed reusable **Terraform modules** for VPC, EKS, RDS, IAM, S3, and monitoring stacks, reducing infrastructure provisioning time by **35%** across multiple client environments.

- Resolved recurring Kubernetes pod restart issues caused by memory limits, missing readiness probes, and wrong environment variables by tuning resources and adding health checks.
- Implemented secure **secrets management** using AWS Secrets Manager, Kubernetes Secrets, and GitHub encrypted secrets, reducing plaintext configuration exposure by **40%**.
- Built blue-green and rolling deployment strategies for backend APIs and worker services, helping teams release new features without downtime during peak traffic periods.
- Improved production observability with **Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch**, and structured application logs, reducing mean time to detect incidents by **30%**.
- Fixed Docker image build failures caused by dependency conflicts and large base images by upgrading build stages, pinning package versions, and using slim images.
- Created automated backup and restore workflows for PostgreSQL and Redis environments, improving disaster recovery readiness and reducing manual recovery effort by **25%**.
- Collaborated with backend, frontend, QA, and product teams to standardize release workflows, making DevOps support more flexible across urgent fixes and planned deployments.
- Hardened Kubernetes RBAC, namespace isolation, image scanning, and ingress security rules, improving compliance posture for healthcare and enterprise SaaS clients.
- Documented CI/CD standards, infrastructure runbooks, rollback steps, and incident response procedures so new engineers could onboard faster and operate safely.

Hexaview Technologies Inc.

Software Engineer

New York, NY | Jul 2018 – Mar 2023

- Built and maintained **AWS** and **Azure** cloud infrastructure for fintech and enterprise applications using **Terraform 1.x, Docker**, and **Kubernetes**, improving environment consistency by **30%**.
- Migrated monolithic deployment workflows from manually managed virtual machines to containerized services, reducing deployment time by **37%** and improving release confidence.
- Implemented **Jenkins 2.x** and **GitLab CI/CD** pipelines for Java, Node.js, and Python services with automated tests, artifact publishing, and environment promotion.
- Solved frequent production timeout issues by analyzing load balancer logs, container resource usage, and database latency, then tuning autoscaling and connection limits.
- Created infrastructure templates for networking, compute, database, storage, and IAM resources, helping teams launch staging and production environments with fewer mistakes.
- Introduced **Prometheus, Grafana**, and ELK dashboards for API latency, pod health, CPU usage, memory usage, and error trends, reducing incident investigation time by **29%**.
- Improved cloud cost visibility by tagging resources, cleaning unused volumes, right-sizing instances, and scheduling non-production workloads, reducing monthly spend by **22%**.
- Fixed pipeline failures related to missing environment variables, outdated credentials, and inconsistent build agents by centralizing configuration and credential rotation.
- Supported migration from older Docker Compose deployments to Kubernetes workloads using Helm charts, ingress rules, config maps, secrets, and deployment manifests.
- Implemented container security checks, dependency scanning, branch protection, and approval gates to reduce risky deployments before production release.
- Worked flexibly across infrastructure automation, release support, cloud debugging, and developer enablement whenever delivery teams needed urgent DevOps ownership.

SimbirSoft Company

Software Developer

Boston, MA | Mar 2015 – Jun 2018

- Maintained Linux-based application environments for eCommerce and business platforms using **Ubuntu**, **Nginx**, **Docker**, **Bash**, and early cloud deployment practices.
- Automated repetitive server setup tasks with **Bash**, **Ansible 2.x**, and reusable configuration scripts, reducing manual environment preparation time by **31%**.
- Improved application uptime by **24%** by configuring Nginx reverse proxies, SSL certificates, service restart policies, and basic monitoring for production servers.
- Troubleshoot database connection errors, disk space alerts, and deployment permission issues by reviewing logs, fixing service users, and improving backup rotation.
- Migrated several legacy applications from manually configured servers to Docker-based environments, making local testing and deployment behavior more consistent.
- Implemented centralized logging with ELK-based tooling and structured log formats, helping developers identify API failures and background job errors faster.
- Created shell scripts for build packaging, artifact movement, service restart, and smoke testing, reducing release mistakes during weekly deployment cycles.
- Supported PostgreSQL and MySQL backup jobs, restore testing, and migration scripts, improving recovery confidence for customer-facing business applications.
- Configured firewall rules, SSH access policies, server users, and environment variable handling to improve basic infrastructure security and operational control.
- Worked closely with software engineers to debug production issues, explain infrastructure limits, and deliver practical fixes without blocking feature delivery.

Microsoft

Software Developer Intern

Cambridge, MA | Aug 2014 – Feb 2015

- Supported internal cloud automation tasks using **PowerShell**, **Azure**, build scripts, and deployment validation tools for engineering productivity improvements.
- Created small automation utilities for environment checks, log collection, and deployment verification, reducing repetitive manual validation work by **20%**.
- Assisted senior engineers with pipeline troubleshooting, build errors, failed test stages, and configuration mismatch issues across internal development environments.
- Improved internal documentation for deployment steps, rollback notes, and environment setup, helping new team members understand operational workflows faster.
- Worked with **Azure DevOps-style** build and release practices to understand source control, artifact management, approval workflows, and release coordination.
- Investigated script failures caused by missing permissions, incorrect paths, and inconsistent machine settings, then proposed safer validation checks before execution.
- Helped test infrastructure changes in lower environments before production promotion, reducing risk from configuration mistakes and incomplete deployment packages.
- Learned practical DevOps fundamentals across cloud operations, automation scripting, monitoring concepts, and cross-team communication inside enterprise engineering.
- Contributed to small tooling improvements that made build validation more repeatable, traceable, and easier for engineers to use during release preparation.

Projects

- ❖ **Distributed Analytics Platform** – Built a Python-based analytics system with AWS and GCP integrations to handle large-scale real-time data ingestion and reporting.
- ❖ **Cloud Migration Toolkit** – Designed a containerized migration solution using Docker and Kubernetes to modernize legacy applications and streamline deployments.
- ❖ **Healthcare API Gateway** – Implemented secure microservice APIs with Python, Node.js, and MongoDB, enabling interoperability across healthcare platforms.

Certifications

- ❖ AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- ❖ Google Cloud Professional Cloud Developer
- ❖ Docker Certified Associate

Education

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (2010 – 2014)